

Employability Readiness – Evidence-Based Reflection

1. Evidence-Based Self-Reflection & Lecture Impact Analysis

During my internship at Vihi IT Solutions from September 2025 to March 2026, I experienced a significant challenge while developing the Mega Power Gym Management System. I was responsible for both frontend and backend development of the system. Close to a sprint deadline, I identified a critical issue in the Stripe payment integration. Although payments were successfully processed, the system failed to update the membership status correctly. This could have resulted in users not receiving access after payment, which would directly impact both customer trust and business operations. Despite the pressure to meet the deadline, I chose not to ignore the issue. Instead, I debugged the webhook logic, corrected the backend flow, and retested the entire system. The issue was resolved successfully, and the system was delivered with stable functionality. This incident reflects my accountability and problem-solving skills but also highlights a weakness in time estimation under pressure. Accountability – 4/5: Took ownership of full-stack development. Risk: Overcommitting. Communication – 3/5: Participated in meetings. Risk: Delayed issue communication. Teamwork – 4/5: Collaborated in POS system. Risk: Prefer independent work. Adaptability – 5/5: Worked across multiple technologies. Risk: Reduced deep focus. Professional Discipline – 4/5: Followed Agile practices. Risk: Over-focus on perfection. A key lecture idea was that “your behavior under pressure defines your professional identity.” This changed my thinking to prioritize quality and responsibility over speed.

2. Industry Alignment & Professional Judgment

For a Junior Software Engineer role, key skills include full-stack development, database management, and teamwork. I have experience with React, Node.js, and MySQL through internship projects, but need improvement in scalability and optimization. I also have database experience using Prisma and Sequelize, though large-scale optimization is an area to improve. I worked with Git and Agile teams, but need more exposure to large team environments. In an ethical scenario where a critical bug is ignored, I would communicate the risk and suggest fixing it or requesting a delay. This reflects my commitment to responsibility and integrity. I have moderate confidence in handling such situations professionally.

3. My Immediate Upgrade Plan

1. Develop and deploy a full-stack MERN application with authentication and payment integration.
2. Participate in at least two technical presentations or mock interviews monthly.
3. Learn system design concepts and practice weekly design problems. These steps will improve my employability readiness within the next six months.